

A Choice That Has a Cost: Pressure Builds

有代价的选择：压力上升

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The pressure built during the second winter, and the **price** of the **good** name of the group was suddenly very **high**. “We must **consider** the **value** of the **store** as well as the story,” the director said. “A **fixed** rate is **worth** less than a **fixed** habit.” The state, the market, and the social interest were, yet again, in the same room.

The **deep** problem was that nobody wanted to **carry** the **burden** of a **withdrawal**. “**Lay** the offer on the table and let them refuse it,” Maya said. “An **option** that we never offer is an **imitation** of a choice.” The **overwhelming** part was the **timing**: the law required an answer during a week when nobody was in the office.

The **cry** of the tenants was reasonable and the **instinct** of the council was not. “Just because a policy is political does not mean it must be mean,” the treasurer said. “A **rare** chance and a **smart advance** could still meet in the middle.”

The **advance** they were offered was an **addition** to the budget with a **deep** condition attached: an **equivalent** cut somewhere else. “Do not **excuse** the **burden** with a **toy**,” Lin said. “The **depth** of the cut matters more than the height of the **promise**.”

The **fixed** sums, the **treasure** of the archive, and the **worthy** names on the wall were all counted **backward** from the result. “**Persistence** is not **deliberation**,” the auditor said. “A **deliberation** that inflates the estimate is a **gamble** with public money.”

The **shameful** part was the **withdrawal** of the second audit. A **rouse** of hope, an **invalid** measurement, and a demand for **respect**: the pressure had produced a decision that nobody could call **good**, and the group had to decide whether to sign it. The policy was never just during the meeting, and the money under the political story was not nothing. The right and the social state had met before; the market, the law, the interest, and the government had all signed. A **bad carry**, a **fixed miss**, a **high cry**, and a **respect** that was **equal**: the **price** was **worth** it, and the **deep value** was in the **store**, not in the **value** of the **option**. **Ahead** of the meeting, a **fan** of the old scheme and a **burden** of paperwork were laid on the same table.

中文翻译

压力在第二个冬天累积起来，而小组好名声的价格忽然变得非常高。“我们必须把这家店的价值和这个故事一起考虑，”主管说，“一个固定的费率不如一个固定的习惯值钱。”国家、市场和社会利益，又一次在同一个房间里。

深层的问题在于没有人愿意承担撤出的重负。“把这份报价摊在桌上，让他们拒绝，”曼雅说，“一个我们从不给出的选项，是对选择的模仿。”压倒性的部分是时机：法律要求在一个没人在办公室的那一周里给出答复。

租客的呼声是合理的，而议会的本能不是。“仅仅因为一项政策是政治性的，并不意味着它必须是刻薄的，”司库说，“一个罕见的机会和一次聪明的进展，仍然可以在中间相遇。”

他们得到的那项进展是对预算的一笔追加，附着一个深层的条件：在别处等额削减。“不要用一个玩具来为这个重负开脱，”林伟说，“削减的深度比承诺的高度更要紧。”

固定的金额、档案里的财宝，以及墙上那些值得尊敬的名字，全都是从结果往前倒数出来的。“坚持不是审议，”审计员说，“一场把估算吹大的审议，是用公共资金赌博。”

可耻的部分是第二次审计的撤回。一次希望的觉醒、一次无效的测量，以及对尊重的索求：压力促成了一项没人能称之为好的决定，而小组必须决定是否签字。这项政策在会议期间从来不是公正的，而政治故事底下的钱也不是无关紧要的。右派与社会国家从前见过面；市场、法律、利益集团和政府都已签了字。一次糟糕的搬运、一次固定的失误、一声高声的叫喊，以及一份平等的尊重：这个代价是值得的，而深厚的价值在那家店里，不在那个选项的价值里。会议之前，一个旧方案的拥护者和一堆文书负担被摆在了同一张桌上。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
good gud POS: n	n. 善行, 好处, 利益; a. 好的, 优良的, 上等的, 愉快的, 有益的, 好心的, 慈善的, 虔诚的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. benefit; n. moral excellence or admirableness; n. that which is pleasing or valuable or useful; a. having des...
high hai POS: n	n. 高度, 高处; a. 高的, 高级的, 主要的, 高尚的, 高原的, 高音的, 昂贵的, 傲慢的; adv. 高度地, 奢侈地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a lofty level or position or degree; n. an air mass of higher than normal pressure; n. a state of sustained...
bad bæd POS: a	a. 坏的; n. 坏; adv. 坏地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. that which is below standard or expectations as of ethics or decency; a. having undesirable or negative qua...
carry 'kæri POS: n	n. 进位, 射程, 运载; vt. 携带, 运送, 支持, 传送, 包含; vi. 被携带, 能达到; [计] 进位; 进位数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of carrying something; v. have with oneself; have on one's person; v. serve as a means for expressin...
consider kən'sidɪŋ POS: v	v. 考虑, 思考, 认为 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take into consideration for exemplifying purposes; v. show consideration for; take into account; v. think ab...
price prais POS: n	n. 价格, 代价, 价值; vt. 定...的价格 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the amount of money needed to purchase something; n. value measured by what must be given or done or underg...
value 'vælju: POS: n	n. 价值, 价格, 购买力, 评价, 估价, 计算结果; vt. 评价, 估价, 重视; [计] 计算结果 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a numerical quantity measured or assigned or computed; n. the quality (positive or negative) that renders s...
store sto: POS: n	n. 商店, 贮藏, 仓库, 备用品, 存储器; vt. 储存, 贮藏, 供给; vi. 贮藏; a. 贮藏的, 现成的; [计] 存储器操作; ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a supply of something available for future use; v. keep or lay aside for future use; v. find a place for and...
lay lei POS: vt	vt. 放置, 产, 铺设, 布置, 提出, 平息; vi. 下蛋, 打赌; n. 位置, 层, 隐藏处; a. 世俗的, 外行的; lie的过去式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. put in a horizontal position; v. prepare or position for action or operation; v. lay eggs; v. impose as a dut...
miss mis POS: n	n. 失误, 避免, 失败, 小姐; vt. 未得到, 未达到, 未听到, 未觉察, 逃脱, 遗漏, 错过, 思念; vi. 失败, 击不中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a failure to hit (or meet or find etc); n. a form of address for an unmarried woman; v. fail to perceive or...
deep di:p POS: a	a. 深的; adv. 深入地; n. 深渊, 深处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the central and most intense or profound part; n. literary term for an ocean; a. relatively deep or strong; ...
worth wə:θ POS: n	n. 价值, 财产; a. 值...的, 值得的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an indefinite quantity of something having a specified value; n. the quality that renders something desirab...
ahead ə'hed POS: a	a. 领先的, 预先的, 向前的; adv. 领先, 预先, 向前, 胜于, 在前面, 在将来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having the leading position or higher score in a contest; r. at or in the front; r. toward the future; forwa...
option 'ɒpʃən POS: n	n. 选择权, 挑选, 选项; [计] 选项 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the right to buy or sell property at an agreed price; the right is purchased and if it is not exercised by...
fan fæn POS: n	n. 风扇, 迷, 狂热者, 爱好者; vt. 煽动, 刺激, 吹拂; vi. 飘动, 成扇形散开 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a device for creating a current of air by movement of a surface or surfaces; n. an ardent follower and admi...
cry krai POS: n	n. 叫声, 哭声, 大叫; vi. 哭, 叫, 喊; vt. 叫喊, 大声说, 哭出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a loud utterance; often in protest or opposition; n. a loud utterance of emotion (especially when inarticul...
promise 'promis POS: n	n. 诺言, 约定的事情, 有指望; vt. 允诺, 约定, 预示; vi. 允诺, 有前途, 有指望 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a verbal commitment by one person to another agreeing to do (or not to do) something in the future; n. grou...
respect ri'spekt POS: n	n. 尊敬, 尊重, 问候; vt. 尊敬, 注意, 遵守 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually preceded by 'in') a detail or point; n. an attitude of admiration or esteem; v. regard highly; thin...
equal 'i:kwəl POS: n	n. 对手, 匹敌, 同辈; a. 相等的, 平等的, 胜任的, 合适的, 平静的, 不相上下的; vt. 等于, 比得上; [计] 等长度编码 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be identical or equivalent to; v. be equal to in quality or ability; v. make equal, uniform, corresponding, ...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
rare reə POS: a	a. 稀罕的, 罕有的, 珍奇的, 稀薄的, 半熟的, 非常好的; adv. 非常 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. not widely known; especially valued for its uncommonness; s. recurring only at long intervals; s. not widely...
smart smɑ:t POS: a	a. 聪明的, 漂亮的, 刺痛的, 剧烈的, 敏捷的, 巧妙的, 伶俐的, 潇洒的; n. 刺痛, 痛苦; vi. 刺痛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a kind of pain such as that caused by a wound or a burn or a sore; a. showing mental alertness and calculat...
advance əd'vɑ:ns POS: n	n. 前进, 进展, 行过的路程; vi. 前进, 进展, 提高, 上涨; vt. 使前进, 促进, 提出, 提高, 使提前, 预付; a. 前... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an amount paid before it is earned; n. increase in price or value; v. move forward, also in the metaphorical...
addition ə'dɪʃən POS: n	n. 加法, 增加的人(或物); [计] 加法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a component that is added to something to improve it; n. the act of adding one thing to another; n. a quanti...
depth depθ POS: n	n. 深度, 深处, 深奥; [计] 深度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the extent downward or backward or inward; n. degree of psychological or intellectual profundity; n. (usuall...
fixed fɪkst POS: a	a. 固定的, 不变的; [法] 固定的, 确定的, 不变的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (of a number) having a fixed and unchanging value; s. fixed and unmoving; a. securely placed or fastened or...
toy tɔɪ POS: n	n. 玩具, 小玩意儿, 小型的东西, 消遣; a. 供玩耍的, 作为玩具的; vi. 玩弄, 戏弄, 调情 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a nonfunctional replica of something else (frequently used as a modifier); n. a device regarded as providin...
burden 'bɜ:dn POS: n	n. 负担, 重载, 担子, 责任; vt. 装货于, 烦扰, 使负担 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an onerous or difficult concern; n. the central idea that is expanded in a document or discourse; v. weight...
equivalent i'kwɪvələnt POS: n	n. 同等物, 等价物, 相等物; a. 相等的, 相当的, 同意义的; [计] 等价的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person or thing equal to another in value or measure or force or effect or significance etc; n. the atomi...
excuse ɪk'skju:z POS: vt	vt. 原谅, 申辩, 做为...的托辞; n. 致歉, 理由, 饶恕, 借口 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a defense of some offensive behavior or some failure to keep a promise etc.; n. a note explaining an absenc...
withdrawal wɪð'drɔ:l POS: n	n. 提款, 撤退, 退回, 撤消, 退隐, 戒毒过程; [医] 戒除, 脱瘾 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a retraction of a previously held position; n. the act of taking out money or other capital; n. the act of w...
overwhelming .əʊvə'hwelmlɪŋ POS: a	a. 压倒性的, 无法抵抗的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v overcome, as with emotions or perceptual stimuli; v charge someone with too many tasks; v cover completely or...
timing 'taɪmɪŋ POS: n	n. 时间选择, 时间测定, 定时, 调速; [计] 定时器时钟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time when something happens; n. the regulation of occurrence, pace, or coordination to achieve a desire...
instinct 'ɪnstɪŋkt POS: n	n. 本能, 直觉; a. 充满着的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. inborn pattern of behavior often responsive to specific stimuli; s. (followed by `with')deeply filled or pe...
treasure 'treʒə POS: n	n. 宝物, 财富; vt. 珍爱, 重视, 秘藏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. accumulated wealth in the form of money or jewels etc.; n. any possession that is highly valued by its owne...
worthy 'wɜ:ði POS: n	n. 杰出人物; a. 有价值的, 可敬的, 值得的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an important, honorable person (word is often used humorously); a. having worth or merit or value; being ho...
backward 'bækwəd POS: adv	adv. 向后地, 相反地; a. 向后的, 相反的; [计] 倒推 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. directed or facing toward the back or rear; a. (used of temperament or behavior) marked by a retiring natur...
imitation .ɪmɪ'teɪʃən POS: n	n. 模仿, 效法, 冒充, 赝品; [医] 模仿, 仿制, 仿制品 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the doctrine that representations of nature or human behavior should be accurate imitations; n. something c...
persistence pe'sɪstəns POS: n	n. 固执, 坚持不懈, 持续(性), 存留(状态); [电] 持久 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the property of a continuous and connected period of time; n persistent determination; n the act of persistin...
deliberation dɪ.lɪbə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 熟虑, 熟思, 审议; [法] 慎重考虑, 商讨, 审议 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually plural) discussion of all sides of a question; n. careful consideration; n. the trait of thoughtful...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
invalid in'vælid POS: n	n. 病人, 残废者; a. 有病的, 无效的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who is incapacitated by a chronic illness or injury; v. force to retire, remove from active duty, a...
inflate in'fleɪt POS: vt	vt. 使膨胀, 使得意, 使通货膨胀, 使充气; vi. 充气, 膨胀 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. exaggerate or make bigger; v. fill with gas or air; v. cause prices to rise by increasing the available curr...
gamble 'gæmbəl POS: n	n. 赌博, 冒险; v. 赌博, 孤注一掷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. money that is risked for possible monetary gain; n. a risky act or venture; v. take a risk in the hope of a...
rouse raʊz POS: n	n. 觉醒, 奋起, 干杯; vt. 唤醒, 鼓舞, 激动, 使振奋, 惊起; vi. 醒来, 奋起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v become active; v force or drive out; v cause to be agitated, excited, or roused; v cause to become awake or co...
shameful 'ʃeɪmfʊl POS: a	a. 可耻的, 丢脸的, 不道德的, 淫猥的, 猥亵的, 不体面的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s (used of conduct or character) deserving or bringing disgrace or shame; s giving offense to moral sensibilit...